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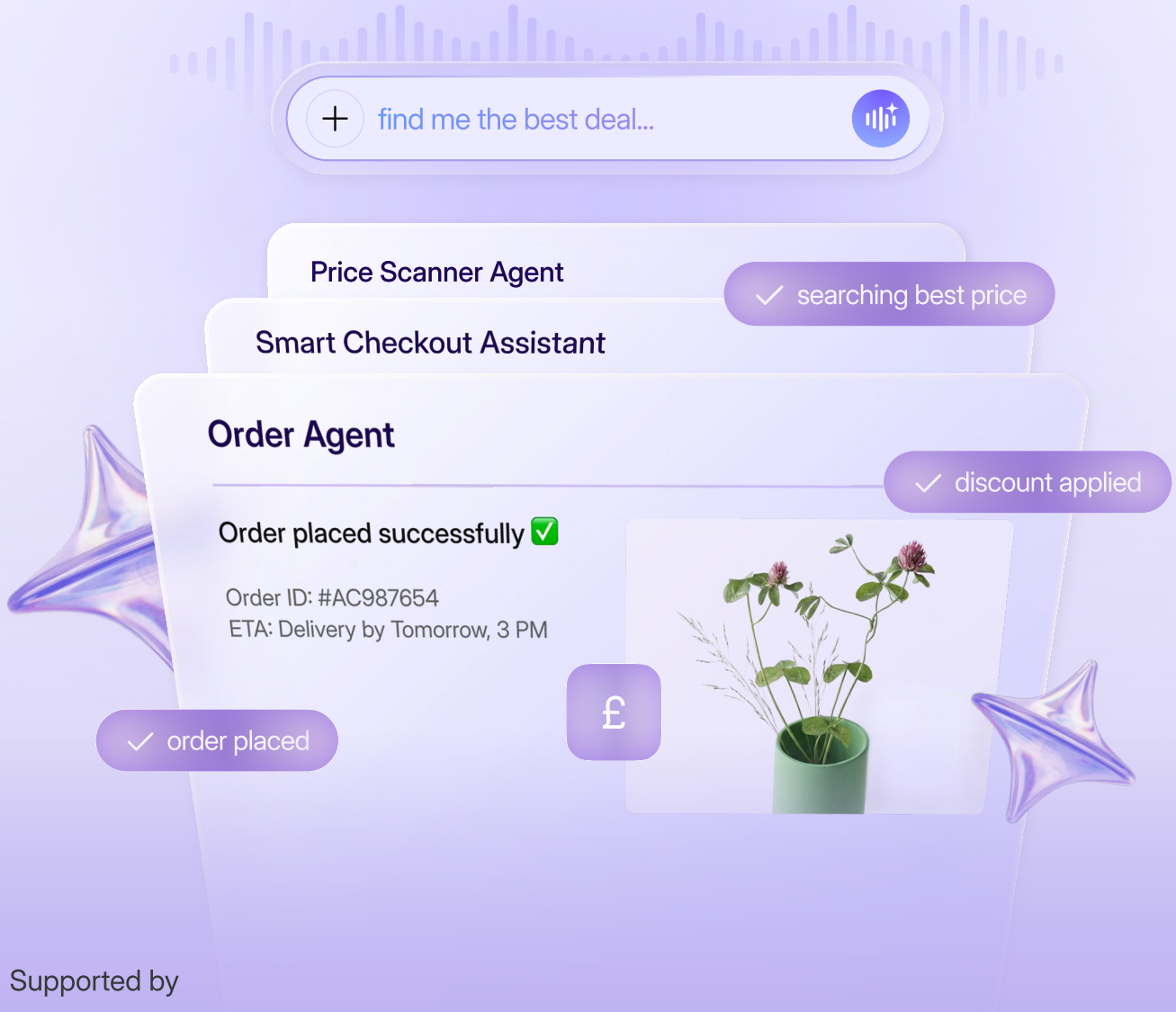
Agentic Commerce

The Next Frontier of Retail

A Whitepaper by Fynd

With a foreword from Chris Moran



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Foreword

Retail has always been a negotiation between what the customer wants and what the merchant can anticipate. The merchant who anticipated best, who knew before the customer walked in what they were likely to need, always won. For centuries, that anticipation was a human skill. It lived in the experienced shop floor, in memory, in pattern recognition built over years of watching people buy. What the last decade has slowly made possible, and what the next two years will make ordinary, is that same anticipation running at a scale no human could ever match, across every customer, every interaction, every moment of intent.

What we have spent the last decade trying to do, in a roundabout way, is rebuild that at scale. The memory, the context, the ability to anticipate what someone needs before they fully articulate it, and to act on it without waiting to be asked.

Retail has a way of dressing up incremental change as transformation. The move to e-commerce felt like a shift. So did mobile. Both turned out to be the same transaction delivered through a different screen, where the customer still searched, still browsed, still decided, still checked out. The journey changed shape but kept its skeleton.

What is happening now removes the skeleton entirely. An AI agent does not browse. It resolves. A customer describes an intention and the agent closes the gap between that intention and a delivered product, often without the customer seeing a single product page. The brand's SEO investment, its merchandising logic, its category architecture: none of it is in the path anymore.

80% of UK consumers are already using AI when shopping. 14% are using AI agents specifically to interact with brands and make purchases, a figure on track to reach 37% by the end of 2026.

And yet 68% of UK consumers say they cannot name a single AI shopping experience that impressed them. That gap, between a consumer base that is ready and a retail industry that has not yet built anything worth remembering, is where the next two years will be decided.

Building commerce infrastructure for over a decade puts you close enough to the problem to see what agents actually need to function well, and how rarely the underlying systems are ready to support them. Clean product attributes, real-time inventory and reliable fulfilment signals are the baseline conditions any agent needs to function, and most commerce stacks today do not provide them consistently. McKinsey research across more than 3,000 e-commerce companies found that product data errors alone reduce clicks by up to 23% and conversions by 14%. In an agentic system, those same errors do not slow a customer down. They simply make the agent choose someone else.

This paper is for the retailer who senses the ground shifting and wants to understand what to do before the window closes. The JIIA deployment inside JioMart's ecosystem of 378 million customers, the AJIO agent handling one million concurrent conversations, Being Human absorbing a six-fold demand spike without a single operational breakdown: these are production systems running today, and they carry clear lessons for what UK retail needs to build next.

The retailers who shape the next decade will not be the ones who have the best products or the largest budgets. They will be the ones who understood, early enough to act on it, that the customer had already changed how they shop. This paper is about what that understanding looks like in practice.

Sreeraman Mohan Girija
Founder, Fynd

Fynd

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Foreword

Over the last three decades, I have had the privilege of witnessing—and helping lead—some of the most significant transformations in retail. I have seen the rise of ecommerce, the emergence of mobile commerce, the expansion of global marketplaces, and the convergence of physical and digital channels into what we now call omnichannel retail.

Each wave of innovation promised to bring retailers closer to customers. Some delivered meaningful change. Others simply digitised existing processes. Yet throughout all of these transitions, one principle remained constant: customers value experiences that save them time, reduce complexity, and help them make better decisions with confidence.

Agentic commerce has the potential to do all three. What makes this moment different is that we are no longer talking about improving how customers search, browse, or navigate digital storefronts. We are beginning to fundamentally rethink the role of commerce itself. For the first time, technology is capable of understanding intent, acting on behalf of customers, and orchestrating entire shopping journeys from discovery to fulfilment with minimal friction.

For consumers, this represents a profound shift. The future customer experience will not be defined by endless scrolling, dozens of browser tabs, complicated product comparisons, or abandoned carts. Instead, shopping becomes more conversational, contextual, and personalised. Customers will increasingly describe what they want rather than search for it. Intelligent agents will understand preferences, budgets, lifestyles, and past behaviours, then curate, recommend, and execute with a level of relevance and convenience previously impossible at scale.

In many ways, agentic commerce brings retail back to its origins. The best retailers have always understood their customers deeply. Great store associates remembered preferences, anticipated needs, and provided trusted guidance. What agentic AI enables is the ability to deliver that same level of personal service to millions of customers simultaneously, across every channel, every interaction, and every moment of need.

The implications extend far beyond convenience. For families managing busy lives, agentic commerce can remove routine tasks and repetitive purchasing decisions. For consumers navigating increasingly complex product categories, it can provide trusted expertise and confidence. For brands and retailers, it creates opportunities to build stronger relationships by delivering relevance, responsiveness, and value at every touchpoint.

Importantly, this transformation is not simply about automation. It is about elevating the customer experience. The winners in this next era will not be the organisations that deploy the most sophisticated technology. They will be the ones that use technology to create the most trusted, seamless, and customer-centric experiences.

As this whitepaper demonstrates, agentic commerce is no longer a theoretical concept. The technologies, infrastructure, and consumer behaviours required to support it are already emerging at scale. What remains is the opportunity—and responsibility—for retailers to prepare their businesses, their data, and their operating models for a world where intelligent agents increasingly become part of the shopping journey.

The retail industry has entered a new chapter. Just as ecommerce redefined where customers shop and mobile redefined when they shop, agentic commerce will redefine how they shop.

For retailers willing to embrace this change, the opportunity is significant: a future where commerce becomes more intuitive, more personalised, and ultimately more human by removing friction and enabling deeper customer relationships.

The next generation of retail will not be measured by the number of transactions completed. It will be measured by how effectively we help customers achieve what they set out to accomplish.

Agentic commerce brings us closer than ever to that goal.

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Chris Moran

Global Business Leader - Retail and Digital

Chris Moran is an internationally recognised retail, digital and ecommerce executive with more than 30 years of leadership experience spanning global retail, omnichannel commerce, digital transformation, customer experience, and emerging technologies.

Throughout his career, Chris has helped organisations navigate major shifts in consumer behaviour, technology, and commerce, leading large-scale transformation programmes that have accelerated growth, improved operational performance, and strengthened customer engagement. He is a trusted advisor to CEOs, boards, founders, and private equity investors, bringing a unique combination of strategic vision, commercial acumen, and hands-on execution experience.

His expertise spans ecommerce, marketplaces, omnichannel retail, digital strategy, AI-enabled transformation, performance marketing, trading, customer experience, and data-driven decision making. He has successfully led international expansion programmes, scaled digital and ecommerce capabilities, and helped organisations adapt to evolving customer expectations across multiple markets and channels.

Chris has held senior executive and advisory roles with some of the world's most recognised consumer and retail brands, including Pandora, Levi Strauss & Co., TJX Europe, Urban Outfitters, Next Plc, Tommy Hilfiger, and Shell. He has also advised numerous private equity-backed and founder-led businesses on growth strategy, digital transformation, organisational design, and value creation initiatives.

Known for building high-performing international teams, Chris has a strong track record of developing customer-centric organisations that combine innovation with operational excellence. Having lived and worked in eight countries and gained hands-on experience across more than fifteen international markets, he brings a genuinely global perspective to the challenges and opportunities facing modern retailers.

Chris holds an MBA and a degree in Economics and Business Finance. His work today focuses on helping organisations prepare for the next era of commerce by leveraging technology, data, and customer insight to create sustainable competitive advantage and exceptional customer experiences.

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Executive Summary

Retail transitions tend to be obvious in retrospect and ambiguous in the moment. This paper examines one that is neither: agentic commerce is already running at scale, the UK market is structurally ready for it, and the window for retailers to build a meaningful position within it is defined and closing.

The findings point to a market where consumer readiness has outpaced retail execution. **80%** of UK consumers already use AI when they shop. **14%** are using agents to make purchases directly, and that number is expected to reach **37%** before the end of 2026. On the payments side, the UK has moved further than most markets realise. **351 million** Open Banking transactions were processed in 2025, and Variable Recurring Payments, which let consumers authorise an agent to buy on their behalf within set limits, went live commercially this year.

And yet **68%** of UK consumers cannot name a single AI shopping experience that left an impression on them. That is the most telling number in this paper. Not because the technology is failing, but because most retailers have not yet put it to work in a way customers notice. The appetite and infrastructure are there. The execution, in most cases, is not.

The gap between a deployment that works and one that disappoints rarely comes down to the AI. JIIA resolves a shopper's natural language request into a completed basket across JioMart's **40 million** products, at a platform that was processing **1.6 million** daily orders by December 2025. AJIO's agent drove a **40%** uplift in purchases while handling over a million concurrent conversations. Being Human Clothing absorbed a six-fold increase in order volume without breaking. All three were built on the same thing: a commerce stack that could absorb what the agent produced.

The paper recommends that UK retailers conduct a thorough audit of their data and catalogue infrastructure before any deployment, begin with post-purchase automation where the commercial case is most immediate, and treat the next twelve months as the window in which a compounding advantage in data, learning, and consumer trust is either built or conceded to those who moved earlier.

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Introduction

A customer recently bought a jacket without visiting a product page, opening an app, or clicking a single link. They described what they wanted in a WhatsApp message, an AI agent found it, confirmed their size was in stock, applied a discount, and arranged next-day delivery. The whole thing took three minutes. The retailer's analytics recorded a direct order. No attribution, no funnel, no journey, just a transaction that happened entirely outside the infrastructure the brand had spent years building.

For a CXO thinking about where their marketing budget goes, what their trading team does, and why their returns rate is where it is, it raises a direct question: how much of your existing commercial infrastructure becomes less relevant when the agent is the front door?

Think about what was bypassed in that three-minute transaction, including your SEO investment, homepage, category pages, promoted placements, upsell logic, and checkout optimisation. The agent evaluated price, availability, delivery terms, and fit before completing the purchase, selecting alternatives whenever product data was incomplete, delivery promises were uncertain, or return policies lacked clarity.

The customer remained unaware of how that decision was made, and the retailer had no visibility into the process.

> *This is agentic commerce, and the UK is particularly well positioned for this shift to accelerate quickly.*

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What ‘Agentic’ Actually Means

A chatbot is primarily designed for conversational interaction. It follows scripts or generates responses to routine questions. An AI agent is different. It’s an autonomous system capable of reasoning, planning, and taking action to complete tasks. It can analyse complex situations, make decisions, interact with multiple systems, and execute multi-step workflows in pursuit of a defined objective.

A chatbot might inform a customer that their order is delayed. An AI agent identifies the delay, evaluates available alternatives, offers a resolution, processes that resolution, updates the CRM, and confirms the outcome, all without human intervention.

Modern agentic AI differs from earlier retail AI in three important ways: it can act without constant user input; it adapts decisions based on changing conditions such as price, stock levels, or delivery windows; and it integrates across multiple platforms and workflows through open APIs, enabling end-to-end automation.

What agents optimise for also differs fundamentally from what humans tolerate. A consumer might re-use a brand out of habit, accept a slow checkout, or fail to compare pieces because it is tedious. An AI agent evaluates price, availability, delivery terms, return conditions, and product specifications continuously, without fatigue, and without loyalty to anything except the parameters it has been given. For brands whose competitive position has rested on consumer inertia, this is a structural threat. For brands with genuinely superior products and clean data, it is a substantial opportunity.

What Deployment Data Actually Shows

Agentic commerce is best understood through what is already working. Fynd’s Kaily has deployments at scale that show measurable commercial and operational impact. Here are some worth examining in detail before the market context.

JIIA

Agentic commerce running at the scale of India’s second-largest quick commerce platform

JIIA is an agentic shopping assistant built by Fynd for Reliance Retail, operating within JioMart across a catalogue of over **40 million** products spanning groceries, fashion, electronics, and home goods. The challenge it was built around was not conversational design but data. JioMart's catalogue had entered the system largely without the structured attributes an agent needs to make accurate recommendations: attributes that source systems rarely carry, such as the aroma of a cleaning product, the occasion fit of a gift item, or the net quantity on a packaged food label. Fynd built a multimodal AI pipeline using Gemini Vision that reads product images continuously and extracts those attributes from the visual content itself, filling gaps the source systems never covered.

That structured catalogue is what makes the customer experience possible. A shopper types 'help me plan a birthday party' and JIIA identifies what the occasion requires, assembles the relevant products across categories, applies available offers, and presents a basket ready to confirm, with discovery, cart

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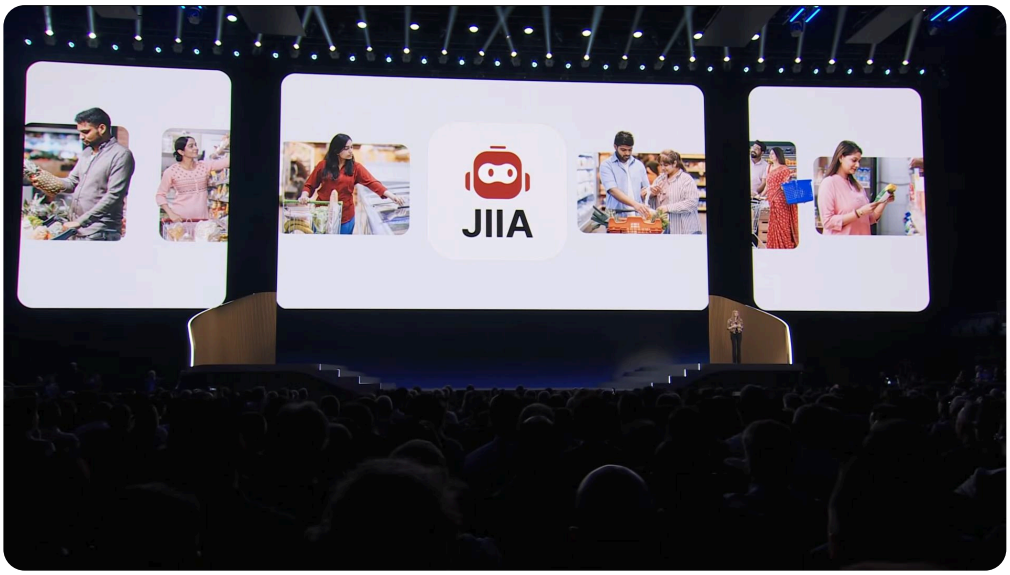
management, and order management handled inside a single conversational flow. By December 2025, JioMart was processing **1.6 million daily orders** across **1,000 cities** and **5,000 pin codes**, making it India's second-largest quick commerce platform by volume.



JIIA featured on Google Cloud Next '26 Opening Note

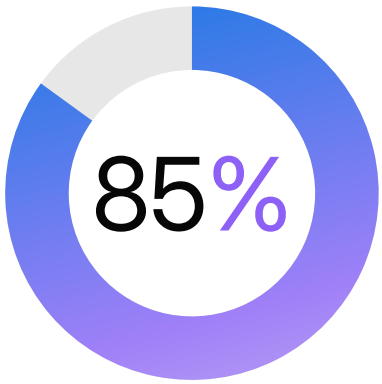
Takeaway

A retailer whose product data lacks occasion fit, accurate quantities, and consistent categorisation cannot build what JIIA built. The agent will make recommendations, but wrongly often enough to matter at scale. Getting the data right before the interface is designed is where the real work happens.

AJIO +

40% revenue uplift from a fully integrated agent

AJIO, one of India's largest fashion e-commerce platforms, deployed ZIP, a conversational AI shopping agent built on Kaily. ZIP automated **approximately 85% of routine customer interactions**, including product discovery queries, order tracking requests, and return conversations, all resolved without human involvement. This level of automation is only possible when the agent is deeply connected to order management, inventory systems, and customer data. ZIP operates as part of the commerce stack rather than as a chatbot layered in front of a website.



of routine customer interactions automated by ZIP

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The more commercially significant outcome is the **40% uplift in in-app purchases** attributable to agent engagement. The agent reduced service cost while also driving revenue by compressing the journey from discovery to checkout into a single conversational flow. During peak periods, the system handled over one million concurrent conversations.

+40% ↑

Uplift in in-app purchases driven by agent engagement

Takeaway

Every routine query the agent handles, including tracking, returns, and stock checks, frees a human agent to focus on more complex, high-value interactions where judgement and empathy matter. That reallocation of effort is measurable from day one, while the revenue uplift from a more compressed purchase journey compounds over time. Neither shows up in the data of a retailer still running a chatbot that cannot access live inventory.

A six-fold demand surge, zero operational breakdown

Being Human Clothing, a widely distributed fashion brand founded by Salman Khan with operations spanning India, the Middle East, and international markets, experienced a **six-fold increase in order volume** while operating on Fynd's unified commerce platform. The question a CXO should ask about a six-fold demand spike is not whether revenue grew, but what broke.

6x *demand surge absorbed without operational breakdown*

The answer is nothing. Without the unified platform, a demand spike of that magnitude would typically produce fulfilment delays, customer service backlogs, inventory mismatches between what the website showed and what was available to ship, and a wave of cancellation and complaint tickets. None of those failure modes occurred. The system absorbed the volume because order management, inventory visibility, fulfilment coordination, and customer service automation were sufficiently integrated to scale without proportional increases in headcount or operational intervention.

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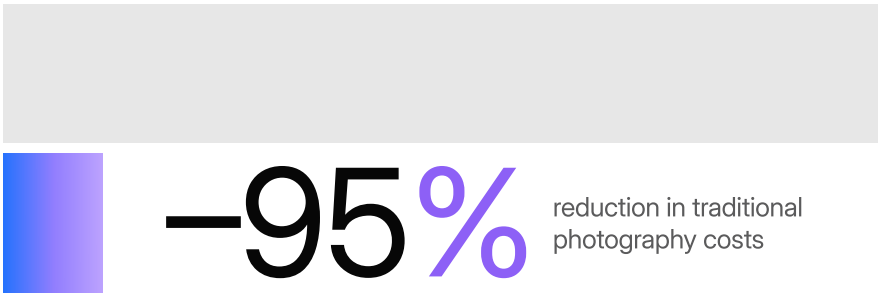
The leadership decision that made this possible was to treat the commerce platform as operational infrastructure rather than a transaction layer. That choice, made before the demand spike, determined the outcome during it.

Takeaway

The cost of operational failure during a peak demand period is not just the tickets raised. It is the customer lifetime value lost to competitors when the brand demonstrates it cannot deliver under pressure. Agentic commerce infrastructure is, at its most fundamental level, a hedge against that failure mode.

A leading UK fashion retailer: building the foundation before the agent layer

One of the UK's largest online fashion and beauty retailers deployed an AI-driven product photography and catalogue automation system, achieving an **estimated 95% reduction** in traditional photography costs. This is an upstream operational application rather than a customer-facing deployment, but it matters strategically: systems that generate structured, machine-readable catalogue data are better positioned for integration with reasoning agents that depend on rich, consistent product attributes. The catalogue investment made today is the infrastructure those agents will run on tomorrow.



Estimated cost reduction in product photography using AI Snap

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Why this is Happening Now

Agentic commerce is emerging at this moment because three long-running developments have matured simultaneously: AI capability, retail infrastructure, and consumer behaviour.

01 / Capability has crossed an operational threshold

LLMs released and refined since late 2022 have demonstrated the ability to manage multi-turn interactions, connect to external tools through APIs, and execute structured workflows. Adobe Digital Insights, which analyses more than one trillion visits to US retail sites, reported that traffic from generative AI sources **increased 4,700% year-over-year** by July 2025, and revenue per visit from AI-referred sessions **rose 84%** in the first half of 2025.

+4,700%

YoY growth in traffic from generative AI sources

+84%

Rise in revenue per visit from AI-referred sessions

Source: Adobe Digital Insights, 2025

02 / Retail infrastructure is finally ready

Over the past 15 years, retailers have invested heavily in cloud migration, API-first commerce platforms, and unified order management systems. Those investments now provide the connective layer that AI agents require. Agentic commerce is not waiting for infrastructure to be built. It is leveraging infrastructure that was originally constructed for omnichannel retail.

03 / Consumer behaviour has already moved

Open Banking payments transactions reached **351 million** across 2025, a **57% year-on-year increase**, with **16.5 million** user connections by December, **up 36%** from the prior year. Variable Recurring Payments, which allow consumers to pre-authorise agents to transact within defined parameters, now account for **16% of all Open Banking transactions**, with the UK Payments Initiative's first commercial VRP scheme live in Q1 2026. Contactless payments account for more than **94% of eligible in-store card transactions.** Consumers are already combining AI tools, messaging interfaces, and digital payments in their daily lives.

of eligible in-store card transactions are contactless

of Open Banking transactions are Variable Recurring Payments

Source: UK Finance & Open Banking Limited

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The Scale of the Shift

For UK retailers, the numbers that matter most are the ones closest to home. Retail Economics and Voyado estimate that **39%** of UK retail marketing and e-commerce spend, equivalent to **£3.7 billion**, will be disrupted by AI by 2030. The UK AI in retail market, valued at **$555 million** in 2025, is projected to reach **$2.47 billion** by 2034, growing at an **18%** compound annual growth rate. These figures cover the technology investment and spend disruption later. The commerce value sitting above them, representing the transactions AI agents will initiate, influence, and complete, is considerably larger. McKinsey projects that globally, agentic commerce could orchestrate **$3-5 trillion** in retail revenue by 2030, while Gartner projects AI agents will intermediate more than **$15 trillion** in B2B spending by 2028. The UK, accounting for approximately **5-6%** of global e-commerce by value and leading Europe in payments infrastructure and digital adoption, sits at the higher end of any proportional share of that global opportunity.

£3.7B

UK retail marketing and e-commerce spend disrupted by AI by 2030

Source: Retail economics/Voyado [32]

£2.47B

UK AI in retail market projected value by 2034, up from $555m in 2025

Source: IMARC Group [33]

$3-5T

Global retail revenue orchestrated by AI agents by 2030

Source: McKinsey [2]

$15T

B2B spend intermediated by AI agents by 2028

Source: Gartner [19]

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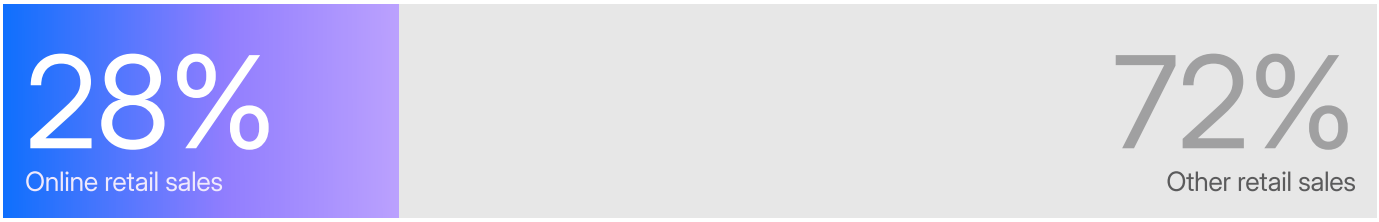
Why the UK is Ready

The United Kingdom is not simply another advanced retail market. Online retail already accounts for approximately **28%** of all UK retail sales, the highest penetration of any major economy in Europe. The payments layer is equally mature: over **94%** of eligible in-store card transactions are contactless, and the UK leads globally in Open Banking with **16.5 million** active user connections and **351 million** payments processed in 2025. Variable Recurring Payments, which allow consumers to pre-authorise agents to transact within defined parameters, now account for **16%** of all Open Banking transactions, with the first commercial scheme live in early 2026.

This matters because AI agents require reliable, programmable payment systems to transact independently. In many markets, this remains a limitation, whereas in the UK the necessary infrastructure is already in place.



Online retail sales as a share of total UK retail

Source: Office for National Statistics

On the consumer side, **80%** of UK shoppers currently use AI tools for shopping or product research, and **70%** expect AI shopping assistants to become the norm by 2026. Generation X and Baby Boomers recorded the largest increases in AI shopping adoption over the past 12 months, at **57%** and **38%** respectively, outpacing younger cohorts on growth rate. These demographics carry higher average order values and stronger brand relationships, which means the opportunity is not limited to younger consumers.

The most commercially useful insight from the adoption data is what it reveals about unmet needs. **68%** of UK consumers could not name a single AI shopping experience that impressed them. The demand is established, but execution remains limited. That gap is where the commercial opportunity sits.

80%

of UK shoppers currently use AI tools for shopping or product research

70%

expect AI shopping assistants to become the norm by 2026

68%

could not name a single AI shopping experience that impressed them

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Use Cases Across UK Retail Verticals

Agentic commerce is easier to understand in application than in theory. Its impact becomes clearer when viewed within specific retail categories.

FASHION AND APPAREL

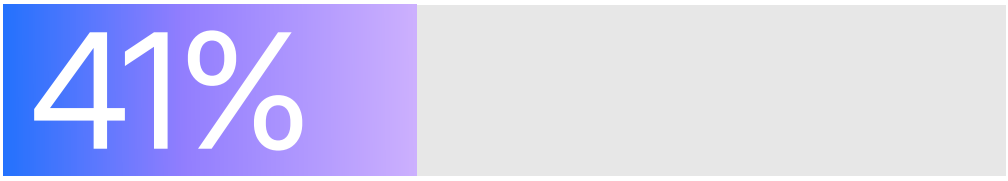
WhatsApp Stylist to Checkout

A customer messages a brand on WhatsApp: *'I need something to wear to a wedding in June in the Cotswolds. I don't want anything too formal. Budget around £200.'*

The agent interprets the event type and likely dress code, references past purchase history and known sizing, filters inventory by budget and delivery timeline, suggests outfit combinations, offers virtual try-on where available, and completes checkout within the conversation.

The Commercial Impact

Higher conversion from intent-driven sessions, lower return rates through contextual sizing, increased basket value via bundled recommendations, and reduced reliance on deep discounting. McKinsey's State of Fashion 2026 found that **41% of consumers trust generative AI search results** more than traditional advertising. Brands must build the data infrastructure that makes agents recommend them consistently.



of consumers trust generative AI search results more than paid search ads

Source: McKinsey State of Fashion, 2026

GROCERY AND QUICK COMMERCE

Autonomous Reorder

Grocery is frequent, predictable, and replenishment-driven. The system recognises patterns: the household buys milk every six days, restocks cleaning supplies monthly, increases fruit purchases during summer.

On Thursday, the agent prompts: *'You're likely running low on your usual items. I've prepared your weekly basket based on past orders and current promotions. Would you like to review it?'*

The commercial impact includes improved retention, higher predictability in demand forecasting, and reduced switching between competitors.

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BEAUTY AND HEALTH

Personalised Consultation at Scale

A customer says: *'My skin feels dry lately. I want something lightweight for summer that won't cause breakouts.'*

The agent references previous purchases, avoids known irritants, suggests compatible routines, offers bundled product sets, and schedules replenishment reminders. In categories where repeat purchase is central to profitability, even small improvements in retention compound significantly.

HOME AND DIY

Making Complex Purchases Simple

A customer says: *'I'm renovating a small bathroom in a flat. I need a compact sink with storage underneath.'*

The agent asks for room dimensions, filters compatible products, flags plumbing requirements, suggests matching taps and fittings, confirms delivery lead times, and schedules installation support if available. Reducing incorrect purchases and product incompatibility directly protects margin in a high average-order-value category.

LUXURY RETAIL

High-Touch Clienteling Without High Headcount

The system remembers a customer's previous high-end purchases, notes upcoming calendar events, recognises brand affinity and budget range, and offers curated previews of new collections. The customer experiences a customised journey without requiring a dedicated personal shopper for every interaction. For UK luxury brands operating globally, this creates scalable personalisation, improved cross-channel continuity, and more efficient in-store appointments.

B2B WHOLESALE

Negotiation, Scheduling, and Sell-Through Optimisation

A regional fashion retailer messages a supplier: *'Restock the top 40 SKUs for Birmingham and Leeds stores based on last quarter's sell-through. Keep total spend within last quarter's budget.'*

The agent pulls historical sell-through data, identifies fast-moving items, applies negotiated pricing tiers, adjusts reorder quantities to optimise inventory turnover, and routes exceptions for human approval only if thresholds are breached. The commercial impact is reduced administrative workload, faster reorder cycles, and more consistent application of pricing rules.

POST-PURCHASE RESOLUTION

Instant, Without Escalation

Customer: *'My parcel hasn't arrived.'*

Agent: identifies the customer, pulls order and tracking data, detects delay threshold, offers three options (refund, replacement, reroute), executes the chosen option immediately, updates order management and CRM, sends confirmation. No ticket. No queue. No manual re-entry. Industry research suggests that AI-enabled service redesign can reduce cost per contact while maintaining or improving resolution time.

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The Architecture of Agentic Commerce

Agentic commerce is not defined by conversation. It is defined by action. Four capabilities make an agent different from every system that came before it.

01 / Reasoning allows the system to move from input to intent

A request like "something warm for a December wedding in Glasgow under £250" is not a query to match, but a set of constraints to resolve across occasion, climate, budget, fit, and delivery timelines.

02 / Memory gives the system continuity over time

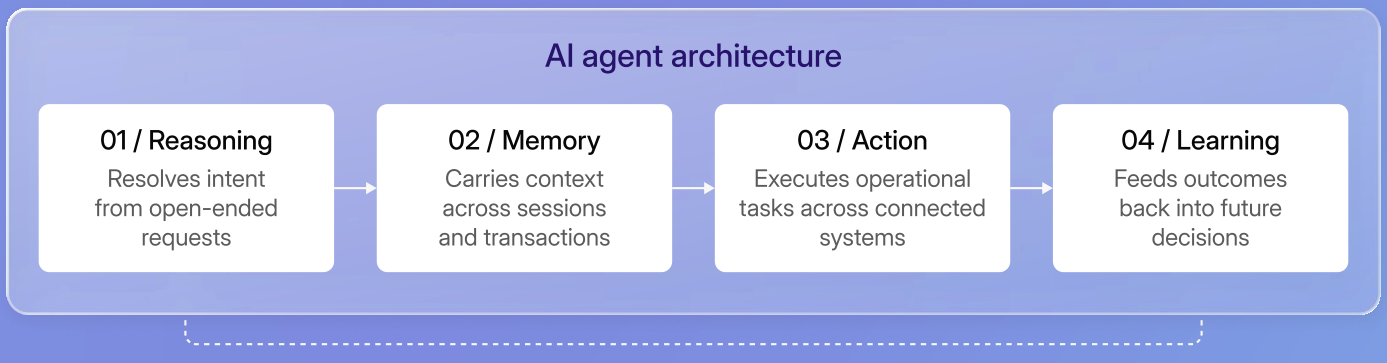
A returned size, a preference for sustainable materials, and a pattern of choosing express shipping build context. In B2B settings, this extends to contract pricing, recurring orders, and payment terms, allowing interactions to evolve into ongoing relationships.

03 / Action makes the system operational

The agent is connected to underlying systems and can execute tasks directly, including checking live inventory, reserving stock, applying credits, initiating payments, triggering fulfilment, and processing returns. Without this layer, AI remains advisory.

04 / Learning closes the loop

Conversion patterns, return reasons, delivery reliability, and customer corrections feed back into future decisions. If certain products consistently lead to size-related returns, recommendations adjust accordingly.



The four capabilities operate as a continuous loop

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The Agentic Commerce Stack

Fynd has spent over a decade building the operational layer of commerce. Kaily brings the agent intelligence that sits on top of it. The two work together because they solve different parts of the same problem: Fynd provides the infrastructure that makes execution reliable at scale, and Kaily provides the reasoning that makes the conversation commercially useful. JIIA illustrates the combination in practice. The Gemini Vision pipeline that extracts occasion fit and product attributes from **40 million** images is the intelligence layer working on top of Fynd's commerce infrastructure. Without the intelligence, the catalogue cannot be reasoned over accurately. Without the infrastructure, the recommendations cannot be fulfilled.

Layer	Component	Function
Conversation	Kaily Agent (multi-LLM)	Natural language interface across all channels
Intelligence	GPT, Claude, Gemini, DeepSeek, Grok + Gemini Vision (multimodal)	Reasoning, intent recognition, real-time personalisation
Action	Kaily Workflows + Boltic (MCP)	Automated task execution, system integration, CRM
Visual Commerce	Pixelbin + GlamAR	AI imagery, virtual try-ons, AR experiences
Commerce Ops	Fynd OMS, WMS, TMS, POS	Inventory, orders, fulfilment, logistics
Data	Fynd Unified Data Layer	Real-time customer, product, and operational intelligence
Storefront	Fynd Storefront	D2C, B2B, marketplace, in-store, quick commerce
Security	SOC 2 Type II + GDPR	Enterprise-grade compliance and data protection

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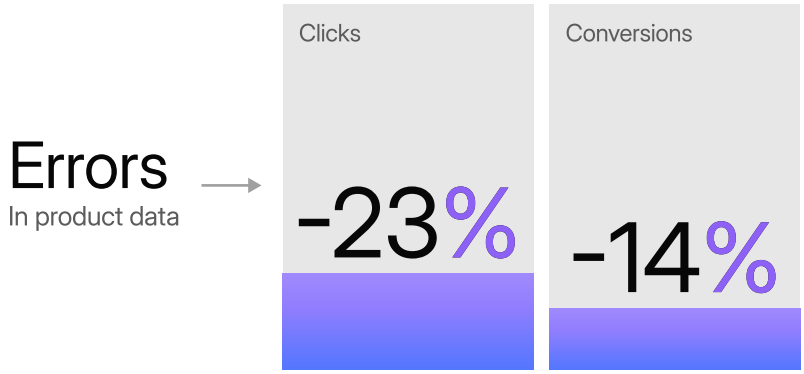
Each layer in the stack has a distinct role, and the value of the system comes from how they connect. The conversation layer handles the customer interface across every channel. The intelligence layer, drawing on multiple LLMs alongside Gemini Vision for multimodal catalogue understanding, interprets intent, maintains context, and makes decisions. The action layer translates those decisions into real operations later, built on Fynd's OMS, WMS, TMS, and POS, and executes those operations reliably at scale. The data layer underpins all of it, providing the unified, real-time view of customers, products, and operations that every layer above depends on. A gap in the data layer does not stay in the data layer. It surfaces in the quality of every customer interaction the agent handles.

Why the Data Layer Is the Real Differentiator

In agentic commerce, the limiting factor is the data the model works with. When product attributes are missing, inventory is delayed, or pricing rules are inconsistent, the agent does not flag an issue. It continues to operate, but the outcomes degrade. This shows up as incorrect recommendations, unavailable items being suggested, or delivery timelines that cannot be met.

The damage accumulates in returns, complaints, and cancellations rather than in any visible system error. McKinsey research across more than 3,000 e-commerce companies found that errors in product data alone reduce clicks by **up to 23%** and conversions by **up to 14%**. That cost is relevant for when humans browse. In an agentic system, where the agent is making recommendations and completing transactions programmatically, those same data errors propagate at speed and at scale across every interaction the agent handles.



Impact of product data errors across 3,000+ e-commerce companies

Source: McKinsey

The consequences show up in returns as much as in lost sales. Sizing, fit, and colour discrepancies account for **45%** of all retail returns, and a further **14%** are attributed directly to inaccurate product descriptions. An agent working from incomplete or inconsistent catalogue data will surface these failure modes systematically rather than occasionally. Conversely, well-structured product data is what enables agents to make recommendations that convert: personalised AI recommendations, which depend entirely on the quality of the underlying product attributes, drive up to **31%** of e-commerce revenue. Two

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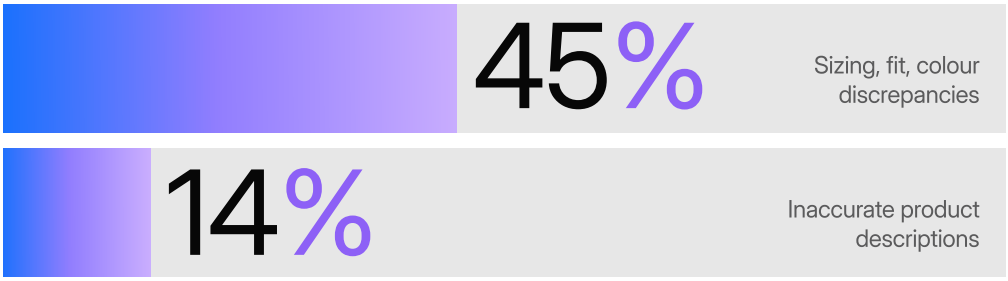
retailers can deploy identical models and see completely different outcomes. The variation traces back to the data each model is working with, not the model itself.



Share of retail returns by cause

Source: Capital One Shopping Research

As systems become more capable, the performance ceiling shifts from the model to the reliability of what it works with. Retailers who invest in clean, well-structured, consistently maintained product data compound that advantage over time in ways that are difficult for later entrants to replicate by switching vendors or upgrading models.

> *"What agentic commerce ultimately exposes is something retail has been able to hide for years: weak data, fragmented operations, and systems that cannot respond in real time. AI amplifies those gaps rather than closing them. Getting the foundations right was never just an IT project."*

Sreeraman Mohan Girija
Founder, Fynd

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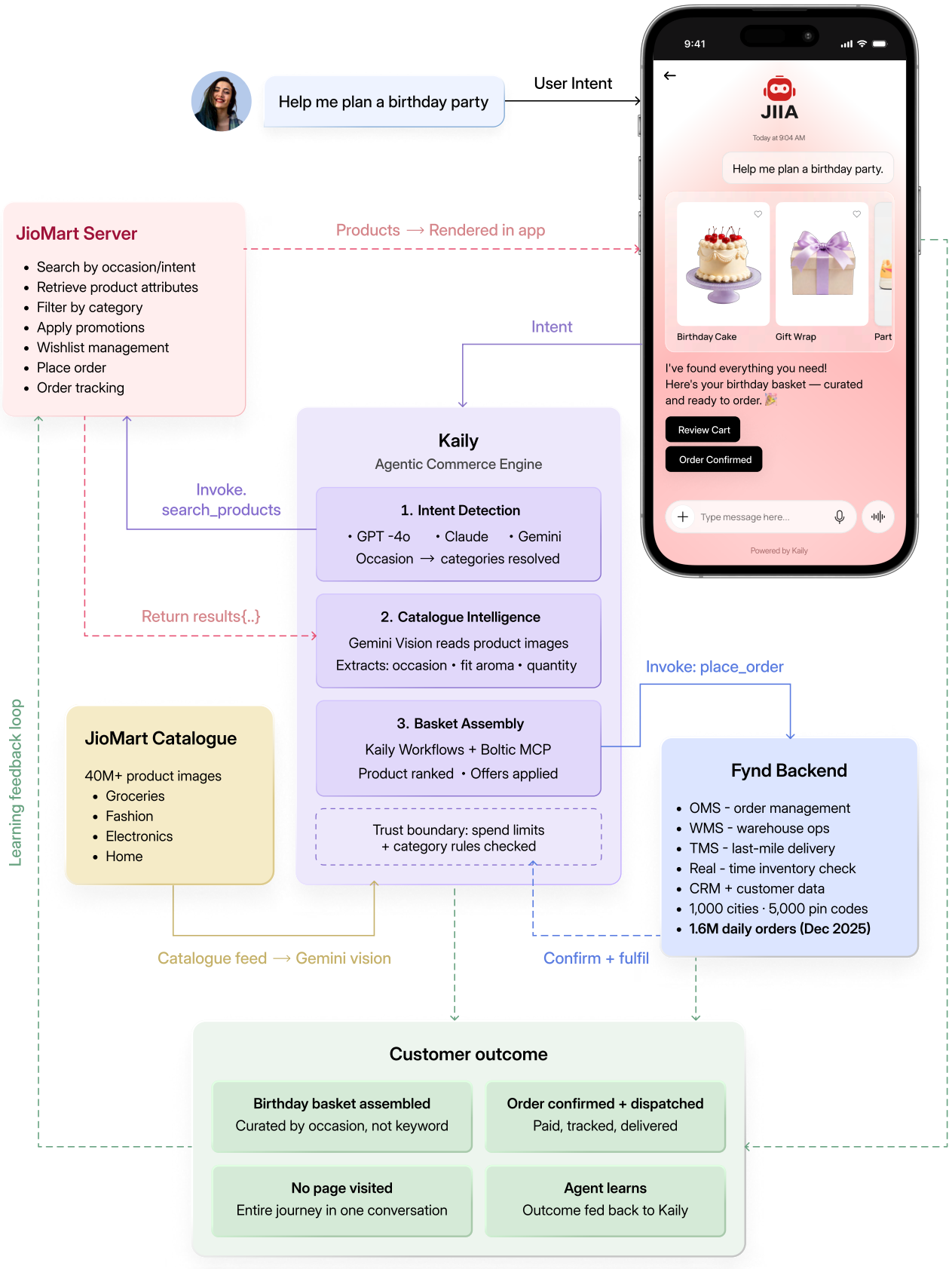

JIIA - Agentic Commerce Architecture

How 'Help me plan birthday party" becomes a completed JioMart order

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The Competitive Landscape

The two-axis framework: commerce depth vs agent intelligence

The agentic commerce market maps across two structural dimensions. The first axis is commerce depth. This refers to how deeply a platform is integrated into the operational backbone of retail, including real-time inventory visibility, order management, payment orchestration, fulfilment coordination, returns workflows, CRM integration, and marketplace connectivity.

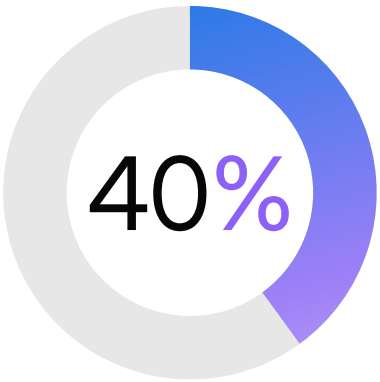
The second axis is agent intelligence. This refers to the ability to interpret open-ended intent, maintain contextual memory, plan multi-step workflows, execute tasks autonomously, and improve through feedback.

The fourth quadrant represents the structural end state. It combines high commerce depth with high agent intelligence. Most current market participants operate on only one of these axes.

The two fatal gaps

Smart agents without commerce depth.

There is a growing ecosystem of AI-native companies building conversational agents with impressive reasoning capability. However, without deep integration into commerce infrastructure, they remain limited. A system that can recommend products but cannot confirm real-time stock, trigger fulfilment, apply dynamic pricing, or integrate with loyalty systems is not fully agentic. Gartner recently warned that **over 40% of agentic AI projects** are likely to be cancelled by 2027 due to unclear ROI and integration complexity. Intelligence alone is not enough. Without operational depth, deployments stall.



of agentic AI projects are likely to be cancelled by 2027

Source: Gartner

Commerce platforms without agent intelligence.

On the other hand, many established commerce platforms have deep infrastructure but limited AI reasoning. They manage orders reliably, orchestrate fulfilment, and expose APIs, but their AI layers are often rule-based or restricted to FAQ-style chat. As AI-mediated discovery increases, platforms without strong reasoning layers risk becoming backend utilities rather than front-end decision engines. BCG notes that retailers that fail to integrate intelligence into their core commerce stack risk disintermediation, being bypassed by third-party agents controlling product discovery.

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Competitive landscape: commerce depth vs agent intelligence

Dimension	Legacy Commerce Platforms	Standalone AI Agents	Vertically Integrated Platforms
Commerce Depth	Strong operational backbone	Limited or API-dependent	Deep, unified infrastructure
Agent Intelligence	Limited or bolt-on AI	Advanced reasoning	Integrated reasoning + execution
Execution	Reliable, but multi-step	Conversational, but shallow	End-to-end inside conversation
Data Foundation	Siloed or partially unified	Dependent on integrations	Unified real-time
Market Maturity	Established, revenue-rich	Fast-growing, venture-backed	Emerging hybrid model
UK Readiness	Variable	Variable	Open banking, WhatsApp, GDPR native

Retailers are moving toward more integrated architectures, either by consolidating capabilities internally or by building tighter coordinated partnerships across vendors. Gartner estimates that by 2028, **a third of enterprise applications** will include agentic AI.

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Strategic Playbook for UK Retailers

The next phase of progress for UK retailers depends on internal readiness. Systems, data, and workflows define what can be executed in practice. This is where strategy becomes important, and where sequencing shapes the outcome.

The Cost of Waiting

Delayed decisions are costing retailers more than they realise.

£38B
Lost to basket abandonment by UK retailers in 2024 *(Retail Economics)[22]*

£27B
UK online returns in 2024, non-food categories *(Retail Economics/ZigZag)[23]*

24%
of all UK online purchases abandoned before completion *(Retail Economics)*

40%+
of agentic AI projects cancelled by 2027 without proper foundations *(Gartner)[19]*

A **£100M** UK retailer losing **24%** of baskets to abandonment loses roughly **£24M** in revenue before accounting for returns processing costs. Agentic commerce does not eliminate these numbers overnight. But every 12 months a retailer delays building the infrastructure and compounds the gap against competitors who are already closing it.

The retailers deploying now are accumulating three things that cannot be bought later: data, learning, and consumer trust. Each interaction the agent handles improves the underlying model for that retailer's specific customers, catalogue, and fulfilment patterns. By the time a delayed competitor enters the market, the early movers will have 12-18 months of compounded advantage that no vendor relationship can shortcut.

Build, Buy, or Partner

Build makes sense when agentic commerce is expected to become a true source of proprietary advantage and when the retailer already has significant engineering maturity: strong in-house product and platform teams, API-first infrastructure, a unified data environment, and enough transaction volume to justify sustained investment. For most UK retailers, that bar is high. Gartner's warning that **more than 40%** of agentic AI projects may be cancelled by the end of 2027 is a useful reminder that internal builds fail when they are treated as innovation theatre rather than operating-model redesign.

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Buy is attractive when speed matters. The problem is that acquisition rarely removes the hard part, which is integration. A retailer may buy a strong conversational AI product and still discover that it does not connect cleanly to order management, pricing rules, returns systems, or customer data. In a market where the real value comes from execution reliability, that is a serious limitation.

Partner is the most practical and least risky path for most UK retailers. The reason is not only cost. It is sequencing. Partnering allows a retailer to start with a narrow use case, prove the economics, and expand from there. A strong partner should bring more than a chatbot: commerce integration, channel deployment, compliance support, analytics, and compatibility with UK payment and messaging realities such as Open Banking and WhatsApp. Because UK consumers are already comfortable with digital payments and conversational interfaces, a retailer that partners well can move from pilot to measurable value quickly.

The Agentic Readiness Audit

Before deciding where to start, conduct an honest assessment across five areas.

Area	The Practical Test	Implication if Unresolved
Data	Can the system answer correctly in real time: 'Is this my size?', 'Can it arrive tomorrow?', 'Am I eligible for an exchange?	Agents make poor decisions on fragmented data; system performance will disappoint
Catalogue	Do products have structured attributes machines can reason with: size, material, fit, dimensions, use case, compatibility, lead time, return conditions?	Agents cannot recommend confidently without accurate, rich product information
Channels	Is the business live on WhatsApp? Which channels do customers actually use?	Deployment limited to lower-engagement channels reduces commercial impact
Workflows	Which post-sale processes have the highest manual cost and volume?	Misidentifying the first use case delays commercial validation
Compliance	Is data processing UK GDPR-compliant? Are there FCA Consumer Duty obligations?	Non-compliant deployments carry regulatory and reputational risk

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The Agentic Readiness Matrix

Where you start depends on your position across two dimensions: operational readiness (whether internal foundations allow an agent to act safely) and customer-facing readiness (whether the right channels and use cases exist to deploy where customers will use it).

	Low Customer-Facing Readiness	High Customer-Facing Readiness
Low Operational Readiness	**Watch and prepare.** Fix data, catalogue, and workflow fragmentation first. Do not deploy agents onto broken infrastructure.	**Pilot only.** Limit deployment to simple FAQ or routing. Prove channel readiness before expanding scope.
High Operational Readiness	**Start internally.** Deploy agents in service desks, store operations, and procurement. Build confidence before customer exposure.	**Scale now.** Begin with post-purchase automation, then guided discovery, then delegated reorder. Expand as trust data accumulates.

Where to Start

For most UK retailers, the best first deployment is post-purchase automation through web chat and WhatsApp. There are three reasons.

The workflow economics are unusually clear. Order tracking, delivery rescheduling, exchange requests, and refund initiation happen at scale and carry obvious cost. The trust requirement is lower, as consumers are more willing to let an agent resolve a delivery issue than to allow it to spend money autonomously.

The UK channel environment also supports this, since messaging is already widely used and WhatsApp adoption is high, which means retailers are deploying into an existing habit rather than creating a new one.

Retail Economics estimates online returns at **approximately £27 billion** in 2024. A single use case that makes resolution fast and controlled creates immediate value on both cost and customer loyalty.

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The 24-month roadmap

Phase	Timeline	Focus	Expected Outcome
Foundations	Month 0 – 3	Audit data, catalogue, integrations, and compliance. Fix before deploying.	Reliable answer to basic operational questions; agentic readiness established
Resolution	Months 3 - 6	Post-purchase service on web chat and WhatsApp: tracking, returns, refunds, exchanges.	**20-30%** support cost reduction; containment rate and resolution speed measured
Guided Discovery	Months 6 – 12	Customer-facing recommendation and product guidance; checkout completion where possible.	**15-25%** conversion improvement from agent-led sessions vs. direct channel
Delegation	Months 12 - 18	Memory, preferences, recurring tasks: Replenishment reminders, reordering, proactive suggestions.	**10-20%** AOV improvement; repeat purchase rate uplift measured
Controlled Autonomy	Months 18 - 24	Limited autonomous actions: repeat orders within budgets, B2B procurement inside agreed thresholds.	End-to-end agentic capability in defined use cases; governance framework in place

What to Measure, When, and Why

Early agentic efforts are often measured using browser-era metrics. Click-through rate, page depth, and bounce rate were designed for navigation-based journeys. They do not capture how agents operate or where they create value.

Measurement needs to evolve with the system.

01 / In the first phase, the focus is operational.

Metrics like automation rate, first-contact resolution, reduction in average

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handling time, and cost per case indicate whether the system is working reliably at a process level.

02 / **In the second phase, attention shifts to customer outcomes.**

Satisfaction, repeat usage of the agent, and containment without escalation reflect whether the experience is delivering value to the customer.

03 / **In the third phase, commercial impact becomes clearer.**

Conversion from agent-led sessions, average order value, repeat purchase rate, and differences in return rates between agent-assisted and non-assisted transactions show how the system contributes to revenue and efficiency.

What changes across these phases is not just what is measured, but what success looks like.

The Regulatory Dimension: What You Need to Know

The UK regulatory environment is broadly supportive of agentic commerce, with the Data (Use and Access) Act 2025, effective from February 2026, making it easier to deploy systems that take decisions based on customer data by removing earlier constraints around explicit consent at each automated step, which signals a clear policy direction toward enabling responsible deployment.

At the same time, there are specific implications that carry direct commercial weight, particularly in how accountability is defined and managed.

The CMA's guidance on AI agents, published in March 2026, makes it clear that responsibility for errors made by an agent sits with the business in the same way it would for an employee, and this applies even when the system is built or supplied by a third party, which means that decisions around vendor selection, governance design, and auditability require leadership-level oversight rather than being treated as purely technical considerations.

For UK retailers operating in Europe, the EU AI Act introduces additional requirements, with Article 50 coming into effect from August 2026 and requiring that customers are informed when they are interacting with AI and that AI-generated content is clearly labelled, making it more practical in most cases to design for this higher standard across all markets instead of maintaining separate configurations by region.

The New Brand Loyalty

One of the most important changes in an agentic market is the meaning of loyalty. An agent does not feel loyalty in the human sense. It optimises for price, fulfilment reliability, return conditions, availability, and compatibility. A retailer can lose a sale not because the customer no longer likes the brand, but because the agent considers another option easier, safer, or more reliable.

Accurate catalogue data, transparent policies, reliable delivery promises, and

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consistent execution are no longer back-office concerns. They are the new brand fundamentals. A brand still needs to be desirable to the customer, but it also needs to be legible and trustworthy to the machine acting on the customer's behalf.

This is why the source of advantage is shifting. As systems become more capable, the bottleneck moves from intelligence to reliability. The ability to support autonomous, machine-completed transactions at scale depends less on model sophistication and more on how well the underlying data is organised and maintained.

The Autonomous Commerce Horizon

Agentic commerce already changes how customers discover and purchase products. The longer-term trajectory extends this from assistance to full autonomy, where connected systems sense, decide, and execute without any human prompt.

01 / Sensing

Connected devices providing the sensing layer

A household inventory system can detect that coffee pods will run out in two days and automatically place a reorder. A connected printer can monitor ink levels and order cartridges before supply runs out. A business procurement system can identify when office inventory falls below a defined threshold and schedule replenishment.

02 / Decision

Predictive systems translating those signals into purchase decisions

Signals become purchase decisions grounded in context: usage patterns, supplier contracts, available budgets, delivery windows and compatibility rules.

03 / Execution

Payment infrastructure that can support automated transactions reliably at scale

The UK's Open Banking ecosystem, with **351 million** payments processed in 2025 and Variable Recurring Payments live in Q1 2026, already provides that foundation.

The number of IoT devices is expected to **exceed 29 billion** globally by 2030, with each device becoming a potential node in a distributed commerce network.

Adoption will accelerate when systems behave predictably and when users retain meaningful control over outcomes. Explainability and override mechanisms are not just good design. They are the conditions under

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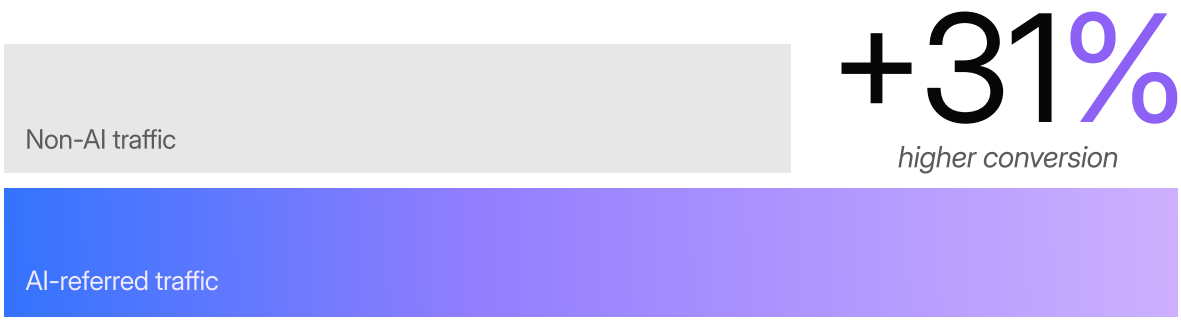
which expanded delegation becomes possible. The retailers and brands that invest in trust infrastructure now will be better positioned as the boundary between assistance and autonomy continues to shift.

The Window is Closing

There is a window open right now, and it is defined by timing.

The technology is already stable enough to deploy. AI-referred traffic in the US is converting **31% better** than non-AI traffic. JIIA is resolving natural language shopping intent across JioMart's **40 million** product catalogue, turning a query like "help me plan a birthday party" into a purchasable basket, at a platform processing **1.6 million** daily orders. AJIO's agent is handling one million concurrent conversations and delivering **40% revenue uplift**. Being Human absorbed a **six-fold demand spike** without a single operational breakdown. The question for a UK retailer is whether they are building their version of this while the market is still forming.



AI-referred traffic conversion rate vs non-AI traffic

Source: Adobe Digital Insights, 2025

Every quarter of inaction has a measurable cost. A retailer that starts now will, by the end of 2026, have 12 months of transaction data specific to their customers, catalogue, and fulfilment patterns. That data improves recommendations, strengthens models, and builds consumer trust in the agent. A retailer that starts 12 months later begins from a position of disadvantage.

The **£38 billion** lost to basket abandonment and the **£27 billion** lost to returns are not abstract statistics. They represent the operational gap that agentic commerce addresses, not instantly, but progressively, as each interaction improves system performance. Retailers that begin accumulating this learning now will, within 24 months, operate systems that are more accurate, more trusted, and more efficient than those available to late entrants.

> *The retailers and brands that act in the next twelve months will define the competitive structure of UK retail for the decade that follows. The window is open. The cost of waiting compounds every quarter it remains unused.*

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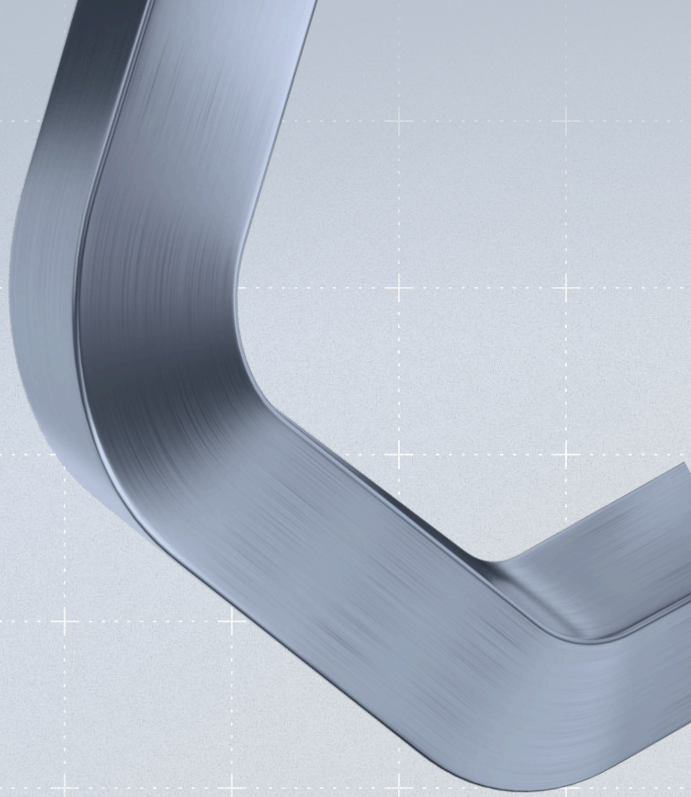

About Fynd

Fynd has spent over a decade building the infrastructure that supports large-scale commerce operations. Its unified data layer, along with order management, warehouse and transport systems, and storefront capabilities, provides the foundation required to run complex, high-volume retail environments reliably.

This infrastructure is already in use across a wide range of contexts. It supports fashion businesses such as Being Human Clothing and AJIO, and underpins retail networks like Surtee Group, which operates 90+ luxury boutiques representing global brands including Giorgio Armani, Versace, and Hugo Boss. Several of these brands have established customer bases in the UK and Europe, giving Fynd operational exposure to international retail requirements.

In the UK, Fynd supports retailers operating across omnichannel, marketplace, and direct-to-consumer models, with systems aligned to local standards such as Open Banking, GDPR compliance, and messaging-led customer engagement.

Kaily builds on this foundation by adding the intelligence layer. It brings together conversational AI, multi-model orchestration, and workflow automation to interpret customer intent and translate it into actions across commerce systems. This combination ensures that decisions made by agents are grounded in live data and can be executed end to end.

For UK retailers, the decision is not whether this shift will happen, but how early to build the capability. Those who invest while the market is still forming are more likely to benefit from the compounding effects over time.

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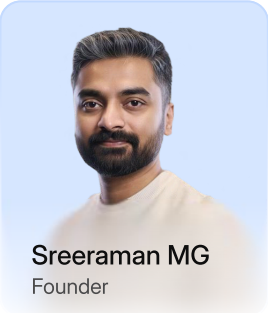
Agentic Commerce

Meet the UK Team



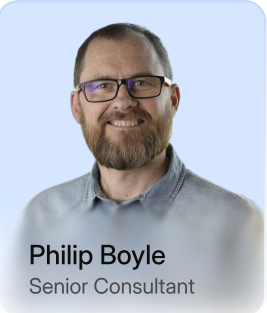
Sreeraman MG
Founder

Ronak Modi
CBO - Global

Vipul Aggarwal
Sales Director - UK

Aditi Thakore
PR & Comms - UK

Shubham Soni
Sr. AE - UK



Philip Boyle
Senior Consultant

Get in Touch

Fynd | London Office

WeWork, 2 Eastbourne Terrace London, England W2 6LG

Shopsense Retail Technologies (UK) Ltd.
Company Number - 17034410
VAT Number - 517184686

uk@fynd.com

fynd.com

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